Past Tenses Teaching Module

Simple Past Tense & Past Continuous Tense Guide (English & Bahasa Indonesia)

GRAMMAR SERIES

MODULE 1: SIMPLE PAST TENSE

English: The **Simple Past Tense** is used to describe completed actions, events, or states that occurred at a specific time in the past. It uses Past Verbs (V2) for action sentences or *was/were* for nominal sentences.
Bahasa Indonesia: Simple Past Tense digunakan untuk menyatakan kejadian atau tindakan yang telah selesai terjadi pada waktu tertentu di masa lalu. Menggunakan Verb 2 untuk kalimat verbal atau *was/were* untuk kalimat nominal.

Sentence Type	Formula Structure	Verbal Example	Nominal Example
Positive (+) *Kalimat Positif*	`S + V2 + O / A` `S + Was/Were + Nominal`	They **visited** the museum. *Mereka mengunjungi museum.*	He **was** a famous artist. *Dia dulu seorang seniman terkenal.*
Negative (-) *Kalimat Negatif*	`S + did not + V1 + O` `S + Was/Were not + Nominal`	They **did not visit** the museum. *Mereka tidak mengunjungi museum.*	He **was not** a famous artist. *Dia dulu bukan seorang seniman.*
Interrogative (?) *Kalimat Tanya*	`Did + S + V1 + O?` `Was/Were + S + Nominal?`	**Did** they **visit** the museum? *Apakah mereka mengunjungi museum?*	**Was** he a famous artist? *Apakah dia dulu seorang seniman?*
WH- Question *Pertanyaan WH-*	`WH + Did + S + V1?` `WH + Was/Were + S?`	Where **did** you **buy** that coat? *Di mana kamu membeli mantel itu?*	Why **were** they angry yesterday? *Mengapa mereka marah kemarin?*

DETAILED STRUCTURAL RULES FOR SIMPLE PAST TENSE

1. Verbal Sentences (Kalimat Verbal)

Uses action verbs. Notice that **V2 is only used in Positive (+) sentences**. In Negative (-) and Interrogative (?) forms, the auxiliary **did** takes the past marking, so the main verb reverts to **Verb 1 (Base Form)**.

• *Incorrect:* She didn't went to school.
• *Correct:* She **didn't go** to school.

2. Nominal Sentences (Kalimat Nominal)

Used when there is no action verb, followed by Noun, Adjective, or Adverb (ANA).

- **Was:** I, He, She, It, Singular Subject
- **Were:** You, We, They, Plural Subject

MODULE 2: PAST CONTINUOUS TENSE

English: The **Past Continuous Tense** expresses actions that were actively in progress at a specific moment in the past, or when another interrupting action happened.
Bahasa Indonesia: Past Continuous Tense menyatakan tindakan yang sedang berlangsung pada saat tertentu di masa lalu, atau ketika tindakan lain menyela.

Sentence Type	Formula Structure	Example Sentences & Translations
Positive (+) *Kalimat Positif*	`S + Was/Were + V-ing + O`	• I **was reading** a novel at 8 PM last night. *(Saya sedang membaca novel jam 8 malam kemarin.)* • They **were playing** football when it rained. *(Mereka sedang bermain bola ketika hujan turun.)*
Negative (-) *Kalimat Negatif*	`S + Was/Were not + V-ing`	• She **was not listening** to the teacher. *(Dia tidak sedang mendengarkan guru.)* • We **were not sleeping** at midnight. *(Kami tidak sedang tidur pada tengah malam.)*
Interrogative (?) *Kalimat Tanya*	`Was/Were + S + V-ing?`	• **Was** he **working** late yesterday? *(Apakah dia sedang bekerja hingga larut kemarin?)* • **Were** you **cooking** when I called? *(Apakah kamu sedang memasak ketika saya telepon?)*
WH- Question *Pertanyaan WH-*	`WH + Was/Were + S + V-ing?`	• What **were** you **doing** yesterday morning? *(Apa yang sedang kamu lakukan kemarin pagi?)*

COMBINING PAST CONTINUOUS & SIMPLE PAST (WHEN VS. WHILE)

1. Interrupted Action (When)

Actions in progress (Past Continuous) interrupted by a short event (Simple Past).

Pattern: `Past Continuous + WHEN + Simple Past`

• I **was taking** a bath *when* the phone **rang**.
(Saya sedang mandi ketika telepon berdering.)

2. Simultaneous Actions (While)

Two continuous actions happening at the exact same time in the past.

Pattern:
`Past Continuous + WHILE + Past Continuous`

• Mom **was cooking** *while* Dad **was reading** the news.
(Ibu sedang memasak sementara Ayah sedang membaca berita.)

MODULE 3: TIME SIGNALS (PETUNJUK WAKTU)

English: Time signals indicate whether a past action was a simple completed event or an ongoing action in progress. Choosing the correct time adverbial clarifies the context.
Bahasa Indonesia: Keterangan waktu menandakan apakah tindakan masa lalu telah selesai sepenuhnya atau sedang berlangsung pada momen tersebut.

Simple Past Tense Time Signals

- **Yesterday:** yesterday morning, yesterday afternoon.
- **Ago:** two days ago, three months ago, a year ago.
- **Last:** last night, last week, last Friday, last year.
- **In + Past Year:** in 1998, in 2015.
- **Just now:** baru saja.

Past Continuous Tense Time Signals

- **At this time yesterday:** pada jam ini kemarin.
- **At [specific time] last night:** at 7 PM last night.
- **All day yesterday / all night:** sepanjang hari kemarin.
- **When / While clause:** ketika / sementara.

SIDE-BY-SIDE COMPARISON OF TIME SIGNAL USAGE

Time Signal	Tense Used	English Sentence	Terjemahan Bahasa Indonesia
Two days ago	Simple Past	He submitted the project two days ago.	Dia mengumpulkan proyek dua hari yang lalu.
At 9 AM yesterday	Past Cont.	She was attending a seminar at 9 AM yesterday.	Dia sedang menghadiri seminar jam 9 pagi kemarin.
Last Friday	Simple Past	We bought a new refrigerator last Friday.	Kami membeli kulkas baru Jumat lalu.
All evening yesterday	Past Cont.	They were studying all evening yesterday.	Mereka sedang belajar sepanjang sore kemarin.
When the lights went out	Both Combined	I was writing an email when the lights went out.	Saya sedang menulis email ketika listrik padam.

MODULE 4: LIST OF 20 COMMON REGULAR & IRREGULAR VERBS

English: Regular verbs form V2/V3 by adding *-ed*. **Irregular verbs** change vowel patterns or remain unchanged. Master these essential forms.
Bahasa Indonesia: Kata kerja beraturan (Regular) menambah akhiran *-ed*, sedangkan kata kerja tak beraturan (Irregular) berubah secara khusus.

Verb Type	Base Form (V1)	Simple Past (V2)	Past Participle (V3)	Meaning (Arti)
Regular 1	accept	accepted	accepted	Menerima
Regular 2	ask	asked	asked	Bertanya / Meminta
Regular 3	clean	cleaned	cleaned	Membersihkan
Regular 4	cook	cooked	cooked	Memasak
Regular 5	decide	decided	decided	Memutuskan
Regular 6	finish	finished	finished	Menyelesaikan
Regular 7	listen	listened	listened	Mendengarkan
Regular 8	open	opened	opened	Membuka
Regular 9	study	studied	studied	Belajar
Regular 10	walk	walked	walked	Berjalan
Irregular 1	begin	began	begun	Memulai
Irregular 2	break	broke	broken	Merusak / Memecahkan
Irregular 3	bring	brought	brought	Membawa
Irregular 4	buy	bought	bought	Membeli
Irregular 5	come	came	come	Datang
Irregular 6	do	did	done	Melakukan
Irregular 7	eat	ate	eaten	Makan
Irregular 8	go	went	gone	Pergi
Irregular 9	make	made	made	Membuat
Irregular 10	write	wrote	written	Menulis

Practice Question 1
Change to Past Continuous: "They eat dinner." (at 7 PM yesterday)
Ans: They **were eating** dinner at 7 PM yesterday.

Practice Question 2
Change to Simple Past (-): "He (write) a letter yesterday."
Ans: He **did not write** a letter yesterday.